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want to extend proficiency to 32-bit controllers, which is the latest in the industry."

With respect to training for students, as mentioned earlier, there is a high demand for mechatronics, as there is a wider scope for

tions. Consequently, this allowed us to minimise our cost of operation and offer quality programmes with the best infrastructure, keeping the cost of the courses competitive."

He adds, "Most of the money is spent on capital expenditure if one plans to set up a 465sqm (5000-square-foot) to 557sqm (6000-square-foot) training facility in Bengaluru. If that can be avoided, it can be valuable for the students." Going forward, he predicts that an integrated programme with colleges by private players will be the way to go.

Virtual-instructor-lead training (VILT) is another model adopted by institutes for training industry professionals. Satish says, "Virtual training is mostly for professionals, working on projects, who cannot afford to spend two or three days at an institute."

Talking about Tevatron Technologies, Kaintura informs, "This year we would also be starting to provide distance education in VLSI design and verification, embedded systems, robotics, mechatronics and functional verification. We are working on a complete package where students can learn from anywhere."

Geographically speaking

Talking about NTTF, Arulselvan notes, "Even though our training centre is in Bengaluru, we are getting a lot of students from Jharkhand, Bihar, Orissa and Uttar Pradesh." He adds, "Although we have three centres in Jharkhand, due to an overwhelming response, we direct them to our other locations."

Some training institutes are observing an equal influx of students

from northern and southern parts of the country. Kaintura says, "Apart from north and south India, this year we are also seeing interest from the north-eastern states. Outside India, we have started getting responses from Greece, Sri Lanka and Brazil."

Satish says, "We see a lot of students coming from Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu and Karnataka. We also have considerable students from north Indian states like Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and Assam."

Prasad notes, "We are seeing many students from Andhra Pradesh and Delhi-NCR region showing a lot of interest in our courses. Generally, about 60 per cent of our students are from out of Bengaluru."

Training for professionals

Industry experts feel that corporate training is on the right track. "NTTF is doing a lot of training for major companies into services and manufacturing. Due to continuous technology upgradation, there is always demand from corporates for training their existing employees," informs Arulselvan.

Satish too observes a rise in demand for professional training. He says, "Public and private sector companies are looking to train their employees to bridge the gap created by changes in technology."

Professionals are always looking to upgrade their skills in this industry, notes Kaintura. He says, "For instance, if an engineer is working on 8-bit or 16-bit MCUs, he or she would

employment and the starting salary is very good. Arulselvan says, "A student, who has completed three years of diploma in mechatronics after his tenth grade, can earn anywhere between ₹ 22,000 and ₹ 28,000 per month at an entry-level." Students looking to pursue their masters abroad are also enrolling for professional development courses.

Need for quality institutes

Industry experts feel that the market size is huge in India in terms of students and professionals, but there are very few good quality training institutions here. Many institutions do not provide relevant training. Experts feel that some institutes provide irrelevant training and there is no connection between the training and industry requirement.

The focus should be on taking the electronics industry to a new level by imparting training on latest concepts, to students and professionals, keeping in mind industry trends. Kaintura says, "Students tend to think that there is a lack of job opportunities in the electronics industry. But if the right kind of mentorship can be provided to them, it would be possible to connect them to the right job profile."

Looking into the future, e-learning will emerge as a strong training methodology, believes Rajesh Suresh Joshi, director, Dynalog Didactic Solutions Pvt Ltd. He says, "Tax relief to the industry providing educational training systems would also help in effective cost control, resulting in large-scale adoption of newer technologies." ●